

Blake Newton (Newt)

Clinical Mental Health Counseling Intern | Refugee Advocate

+1 (828) 361-2724 | Nantahala, NC | blake.newton12@gmail.com

CORE STRENGTHS

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|--------------------------------|----------------------|----------------|
| ✧ Cross-Cultural Communication | ✧ Excellent Judgment | ✧ Reliability |
| ✧ Relationship Building | ✧ Critical Thinking | ✧ Adaptability |

EXPERIENCE

Whitewater Raft Guide | May 2026 – Present

Rolling Thunder Rafting Company, McCayesville, GA

- Built rapport with guests from diverse backgrounds through empathy and effective communication
- Supported participants experiencing fear or anxiety, fostering confidence in challenging situations
- Communicated safety procedures and complex instructions clearly to groups with varying experience levels
- Exercised sound judgment and maintained composure in dynamic, high-pressure environments
- Collaborated with team members to ensure participant safety and deliver positive client experiences

Clinical Experience | May 2025 – May 2026

Student Practicum Intern, Leeke Magee Christian Counseling Center, New Orleans, LA

- Provided trauma-informed counseling to a diverse caseload of clients
- Collaborated with clients to develop personalized, goal-oriented treatment plans
- Implemented evidence-based interventions aligned with clients' needs and goals
- Coordinated scheduling and case management tasks for ongoing client care
- Engaged in weekly individual and group supervision to enhance clinical skills

Receptionist | June 2025 – August 2025

Leeke Magee Christian Counseling Center, New Orleans, LA

- Served as the first point of contact for clients, ensuring a welcoming and professional environment
- Managed high call volume and direct inquiries to appropriate staff or resources
- Oversaw client check-in procedures, including payment processing and appointment updates
- Maintained and organized the counseling center's waitlist for new and returning clients
- Performed daily administrative tasks and close office operations efficiently

Field Experience in Refugee Aid | October 2023 – November 2023

Volunteer, MRDS (NGO), Erbil, Iraq

- Learned how to communicate effectively and sensitively in potentially emotionally charged environments, ensuring a comfortable and supportive exchange
- Practiced attentive listening to identify unspoken needs & interpret non-verbal cues for tailored support
- Gained insights into sustainable aid models that support without undermining the local economy's stability

Cultural Immersion & Community Integration | March 2022 – October 2023

Volunteer, Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia; New York, New York; Durham, NC; Raleigh, NC

Volunteered with various refugee-focused NGOs, including MRDS, Global Gates, World Relief Durham, and Refugee Hope Partners, to better understand global refugee circumstances and learn how to better care for refugees across the system

- Located, established relationships, and integrated with refugee populations, learning to communicate effectively and sensitively in potentially emotionally charged environments
- Self-immersed in a new culture, engaging with and relating to diverse communities
- Established connections, fostered relationships, and built trust within refugee communities, demonstrating empathy and building strong bonds
- Capable of autonomous and self-directed project management with minimal external influence
- Honed adept cross-cultural communication skills, particularly with limited English proficiency

EDUCATION

M.A., Clinical Mental Health, New Orleans Baptist Theological Seminary, *New Orleans, LA* | Expected December 2026

B.S., Environmental Science: Quantitative Energy Systems, University of North Carolina, *Chapel Hill, NC* | 2021

TRAININGS & CERTIFICATIONS

Eye Movement Desensitization & Reprocessing (EMDR), EMDR Support Network, *New Orleans, LA* | 2025

EMDR 2.0, Enhancing Trauma Treatment Institute, *Online* | 2026

Gottman Method Couples Therapy – Level 1 & 2, Gottman Institute, *Online* | *In-Progress*

Story-Informed Trauma Therapy Foundations Training, SITT Central, *Online* | *In-Progress*

LANGUAGES

English: Native

Arabic: Intermediate in Syrian Dialect, Elementary in Modern Standard (MSA)

German: High Elementary

French: High Elementary

Mandarin Chinese: Low Elementary

REFERENCES

Dr. Kelle Falterman | January 2026 – May 2026

Individual Supervisor, Leeke Magee Christian Counseling Center, New Orleans, LA

- kfalterman@nobts.edu

Dr. Craig Garrett | August 2024 – Present

Professor; Divisional Associate Dean of Counseling, New Orleans Baptist Theological Seminary, New Orleans, LA

- +1 (504) 816-8089
- cgarrett@nobts.edu

Rachel H. | August 2018 – Present

Personal Reference, Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia

- +60 (0) 11 1853 1445
- rphotong@gmail.com